

Workday

Sitting on the cleanest HR and finance dataset in enterprise software, and turning it into agents · www.workday.com

2005

Founded

\$9.6B

FY2026 revenue

\$8.8B

Subscription revenue

\$25.96B

Subscription backlog

75M+

Users under contract

01 Overview

Subscription revenue grew from \$7.7B to \$8.8B in FY2026, with subscription backlog of \$25.96B, up 17%. More than 75% of core customers use Workday Illuminate, and over a billion AI actions ran on the platform during the year.

Offering: A unified platform for human capital management and financial management, with Workday Illuminate as the AI layer and a growing set of Illuminate Agents.

Key facts

HQ: Pleasanton, California

Ownership: Public (NASDAQ: WDAY)

Revenue: \$9.6B total revenue in FY2026 (year ended 31 January 2026), up from \$8.4B, with subscription revenue rising from \$7.7B to \$8.8B. Operating cash flow grew from \$2.5B to \$2.9B, and \$2.9B of shares were repurchased. Non-GAAP operating margin around 28.5%

Web: www.workday.com · [LinkedIn](#)

Key people: Carl Eschenbach (Chief Executive Officer) · Zane Rowe (Chief Financial Officer)

Digital twin: No · **GenAI:** Yes (Illuminate)

02 Use Cases & Reported Metrics

Sector	Deployment	Reported impact	Source
AI adoption	Workday Illuminate embedded across HR and finance workflows, with Illuminate Agents introduced to accelerate hiring, improve frontline worker experiences, simplify financial...	More than 75% of core customers using Illuminate AI, with over 1 billion AI actions on the platform in a single...	Link
Data foundation	Illuminate built on Workday's own transactional dataset rather than general-purpose training data — the finance and HR records of its contracted user base.	More than 75 million users under contract and a trillion transactions processed in a single year	Link
Platform expansion	Four acquisitions completed in FY2026 — Flowise (low-code AI agent building), Paradox (candidate experience agent), Sana Labs (enterprise knowledge) and Pipedream (integration...	Subscription backlog reached \$25.96B, up 17%, including the Paradox contribution	Link

03 Competitive Landscape

Other vendors in this market: Adobe · Oracle · Salesforce · SAP · ServiceNow

Where it sits: Workday's claim is data, not models: Illuminate is trained on what it describes as the largest and cleanest finance and HR dataset, with more than 75 million users under contract and a trillion transactions processed in a year.

04 GIP & BlackRock Connections

GIP became a wholly-owned BlackRock subsidiary in October 2024 and now operates as BlackRock's dedicated infrastructure-investment arm. Stakes below are standard institutional/index-fund positions unless otherwise noted.

Entity	Possible connection
Global Infrastructure Partners	No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. HR and finance are universal across PortCos, so this is one of the more plausible candidates for consolidated portfolio-level licensing.
BlackRock	No publicly disclosed operating relationship; standard index holdings of WDAY only.

05 Sentiment

Customer: The adoption data is the strongest evidence of any vendor in this wave: over three-quarters of core customers actively using the AI layer, and AI present in more than three-quarters of net new deals.

What supports the story

- More than 75% of core customers use Illuminate AI, with over a billion AI actions on the platform in a year
- Subscription backlog of \$25.96B, up 17%, with subscription revenue up from \$7.7B to \$8.8B
- HR and finance are universal functions, making Workday one of the few genuinely portfolio-wide candidates

What to pressure-test

- Subscription growth of roughly 14–15% is solid but not exceptional against ServiceNow at 24.5%
- \$166M of restructuring expense in Q1 FY2026 pushed GAAP operating margin down to 1.8% for the quarter
- Four acquisitions in one year carries integration risk and makes organic growth harder to read

Employee: Not covered in this pass. The one concrete signal is \$166M of restructuring expense recorded in Q1 FY2026, alongside management commentary about driving continued efficiencies throughout the...

Sources: Workday public filings/website, company fact sheets, Wikipedia, PitchBook/Crunchbase/Datanyze/BuiltIn profiles, Glassdoor employer reviews, vendor case studies and press releases as of Sept. 2026. Figures marked "est." or "not disclosed" are third-party estimates or unavailable — not company-confirmed — validate in diligence. Part of the Physical AI / Industrial AI for Critical Infrastructure market landscape.